



Animals

Microscopic animals live all around us — on other animals, in soil, or drifting through the ocean. Together with other ocean microlife they create clouds of drifting plankton.

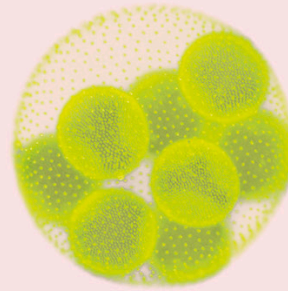
Fungi

Fungi feed on rotting or dead things, and include mushrooms, toadstools, and mould. Their bodies are made of many hair-like threads.



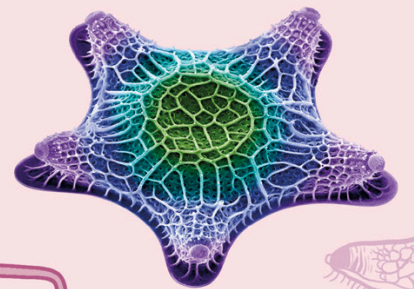
Plants and green algae

Plants and green algae make their own food from the energy in sunlight. Green algae are smaller than plants, but together they produce more oxygen than all of the trees on Earth.



Brown algae and relatives

Brown algae live in the sea, and many look like plants. They are closely related to miniature dinoflagellates, which swim with a tail, and diatoms, forams, radiolarians, and coccolithophores, which have tiny, beautiful skeletons.



Bacteria

Together with archaea, bacteria are the simplest of all living things. They have been on Earth for at least 3.5 billion years and occur nearly everywhere, including in human bodies.

